A well-stocked pantry will save you time and help you rustle up soups even on short notice. With the right ingredients, it will also be a source of inspiration.

pantry essentials

Putting together soups from the contents of your cupboards or pantry is a satisfying experience. Whether you're cooking for unannounced guests or whipping up a quick supper, with a few well-chosen basics on hand, you'll always have the ability to make a tasty soup. Here are the required items.



onions

basic vegetables

Onions, garlic, carrots, and leeks are the basis for countless soups, so it makes sense to have them available at all times. Obviously, they are perishable—store them in a cool, dark place.

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frozen stock and bouillon cubes

A supply of homemade stock is a must. Make it in advance and store it in the freezer. For those days when you're in a real hurry, have some good-quality chicken, beef, or vegetable stock cubes on hand, too.

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a selection of oils

From the best-quality olive oil for garnishing to the more work-a-day varieties such as sunflower oil used for cooking and frying, a good selection of oils is invaluable. The more unusual, like sesame oil, are available in small bottles—a blessing when space is at a premium.



garlic

flavorings

Salt and whole black peppercorns are indispensable in the kitchen, but there are other flavorings worth having in your kitchen cupboard, too. Wine vinegars, sherry vinegar, Worcestershire sauce, soy sauce, and fish sauce are frequently used in soups.